

2)

$$\begin{aligned}
 y'' &= -48(9 - 4x)^2(-4) = 192(9 - 4x)^2 \\
 y''(2) &= 192(0)^2 = 0 && \text{test inconclusive} \\
 y''' &= 384(9 - 4x)(-4) = -1536(9 - 4x) \\
 y'''(2) &= -1536(0) = 0 && \text{test inconclusive} \\
 y^{(4)} &= 6144 \\
 y^{(4)}(2) &= 6144 > 0 && \text{convex, relative minimum}
 \end{aligned}$$

MARGINAL, AVERAGE, AND TOTAL CONCEPTS

4.10. Find (1) the marginal and (2) the average functions for each of the following total functions. Evaluate them at $Q = 3$ and $Q = 5$.

a) $TC = 3Q^2 + 7Q + 12$

1) $MC = \frac{dTC}{dQ} = 6Q + 7$

At $Q = 3$, $MC = 6(3) + 7 = 25$

At $Q = 5$, $MC = 6(5) + 7 = 37$

2) $AC = \frac{TC}{Q} = 3Q + 7 + \frac{12}{Q}$

At $Q = 3$, $AC = 3(3) + 7 + \frac{12}{3} = 20$

At $Q = 5$, $AC = 3(5) + 7 + \frac{12}{5} = 24.4$

Note: When finding the average function, be sure to divide the constant term by Q .

b) $\pi = Q^2 - 13Q + 78$

1) $\frac{d\pi}{dQ} = 2Q - 13$

At $Q = 3$, $\frac{d\pi}{dQ} = 2(3) - 13 = -7$

At $Q = 5$, $\frac{d\pi}{dQ} = 2(5) - 13 = -3$

2) $A\pi = \frac{\pi}{Q} = Q - 13 + \frac{78}{Q}$

At $Q = 3$, $A\pi = 3 - 13 + \frac{78}{3} = 16$

At $Q = 5$, $A\pi = 5 - 13 + \frac{78}{5} = 7.6$

c) $TR = 12Q - Q^2$

1) $MR = \frac{dTR}{dQ} = 12 - 2Q$

At $Q = 3$, $MR = 12 - 2(3) = 6$

At $Q = 5$, $MR = 12 - 2(5) = 2$

2) $AR = \frac{TR}{Q} = 12 - Q$

At $Q = 3$, $AR = 12 - 3 = 9$

At $Q = 5$, $AR = 12 - 5 = 7$

d) $TC = 35 + 5Q - 2Q^2 + 2Q^3$

1) $MC = \frac{dTC}{dQ} = 5 - 4Q + 6Q^2$

At $Q = 3$, $MC = 5 - 4(3) + 6(3)^2 = 47$

At $Q = 5$, $MC = 5 - 4(5) + 6(5)^2 = 135$

2) $AC = \frac{TC}{Q} = \frac{35}{Q} + 5 - 2Q + 2Q^2$

At $Q = 3$, $AC = \frac{35}{3} + 5 - 2(3) + 2(3)^2 = 28.67$

At $Q = 5$, $AC = \frac{35}{5} + 5 - 2(5) + 2(5)^2 = 52$

4.11. Find the marginal expenditure (ME) functions associated with each of the following supply functions. Evaluate them at $Q = 4$ and $Q = 10$.

a) $P = Q^2 + 2Q + 1$

To find the ME function, given a simple supply function, find the total expenditure (TE) function and take its derivative with respect to Q .

$$TE = PQ = (Q^2 + 2Q + 1)Q = Q^3 + 2Q^2 + Q$$

$$ME = \frac{dTE}{dQ} = 3Q^2 + 4Q + 1$$

At $Q = 4$, $ME = 3(4)^2 + 4(4) + 1 = 65$. At $Q = 10$, $ME = 3(10)^2 + 4(10) + 1 = 341$.

$$b) P = Q^2 + 0.5Q + 3$$

$$TE = PQ = (Q^2 + 0.5Q + 3)Q = Q^3 + 0.5Q^2 + 3Q$$

$$ME = 3Q^2 + Q + 3$$

$$\text{At } Q = 4, ME = 3(4)^2 + 4 + 3 = 55. \text{ At } Q = 10, ME = 3(10)^2 + 10 + 3 = 313.$$

- 4.12. Find the MR functions for each of the following demand functions and evaluate them at $Q = 4$ and $Q = 10$.

$$a) Q = 36 - 2P$$

$$P = 18 - 0.5Q$$

$$TR = (18 - 0.5Q)Q = 18Q - 0.5Q^2$$

$$MR = \frac{dTR}{dQ} = 18 - Q$$

$$\text{At } Q = 4, MR = 18 - 4 = 14$$

$$\text{At } Q = 10, MR = 18 - 10 = 8$$

$$b) 44 - 4P - Q = 0$$

$$P = 11 - 0.25Q$$

$$TR = (11 - 0.25Q)Q = 11Q - 0.25Q^2$$

$$MR = \frac{dTR}{dQ} = 11 - 0.5Q$$

$$\text{At } Q = 4, MR = 11 - 0.5(4) = 9$$

$$\text{At } Q = 10, MR = 11 - 0.5(10) = 6$$

- 4.13. For each of the following consumption functions, use the derivative to find the marginal propensity to consume $MPC = dC/dY$.

$$a) C = C_0 + bY$$

$$MPC = \frac{dC}{dY} = b$$

$$b) C = 1500 + 0.75Y$$

$$MPC = \frac{dC}{dY} = 0.75$$

- 4.14. Given $C = 1200 + 0.8Y_d$, where $Y_d = Y - T$ and $T = 100$, use the derivative to find the MPC.

When $C = f(Y_d)$, make $C = f(Y)$ before taking the derivative. Thus,

$$C = 1200 + 0.8(Y - 100) = 1120 + 0.8Y$$

$$MPC = \frac{dC}{dY} = 0.8$$

Note that the introduction of a lump-sum tax into the income determination model *does not* affect the value of the MPC (or the multiplier).

- 4.15. Given $C = 2000 + 0.9Y_d$, where $Y_d = Y - T$ and $T = 300 + 0.2Y$, use the derivative to find the MPC.

$$C = 2000 + 0.9(Y - 300 - 0.2Y) = 2000 + 0.9Y - 270 - 0.18Y = 1730 + 0.72Y$$

$$MPC = \frac{dC}{dY} = 0.72$$

The introduction of a proportional tax into the income determination model *does* affect the value of the MPC and hence the multiplier.

- 4.16. Find the marginal cost functions for each of the following average cost functions.

$$a) AC = 1.5Q + 4 + \frac{46}{Q}$$

Given the average cost function, the marginal cost function is determined by first finding the total cost function and then taking its derivative, as follows:

$$TC = (AC)Q = \left(1.5Q + 4 + \frac{46}{Q}\right)Q = 1.5Q^2 + 4Q + 46$$

$$MC = \frac{dTC}{dQ} = 3Q + 4$$

$$b) AC = \frac{160}{Q} + 5 - 3Q + 2Q^2$$

$$TC = \left(\frac{160}{Q} + 5 - 3Q + 2Q^2\right)Q = 160 + 5Q - 3Q^2 + 2Q^3$$

$$MC = \frac{dTC}{dQ} = 5 - 6Q + 6Q^2$$

OPTIMIZING ECONOMIC FUNCTIONS

4.17. Maximize the following total revenue TR and total profit π functions by (1) finding the critical value(s), (2) testing the second-order conditions, and (3) calculating the maximum TR or π .

$$a) TR = 32Q - Q^2$$

$$1) TR' = 32 - 2Q = 0$$

$$Q = 16 \quad \text{critical value}$$

$$2) TR'' = -2 < 0 \quad \text{concave, relative maximum}$$

$$3) TR = 32(16) - (16)^2 = 256$$

Note that whenever the value of the second derivative is negative over the whole domain of the function, as in (2) above, we can also conclude that the function is strictly concave and at a global maximum.

$$b) \pi = -Q^2 + 11Q - 24$$

$$1) \pi' = -2Q + 11 = 0$$

$$Q = 5.5 \quad \text{critical value}$$

$$2) \pi'' = -2 < 0 \quad \text{concave, relative maximum}$$

$$3) \pi = -(5.5)^2 + 11(5.5) - 24 = 6.25$$

$$c) \pi = -\frac{1}{2}Q^3 - 5Q^2 + 2000Q - 326$$

$$1) \pi' = -\frac{3}{2}Q^2 - 10Q + 2000 = 0$$

$$-1(Q^2 + 10Q - 2000) = 0$$

$$(Q + 50)(Q - 40) = 0$$

$$Q = -50 \quad Q = 40 \quad \text{critical values}$$

$$2) \pi'' = -3Q - 10$$

$$\pi''(40) = -2(40) - 10 = -90 < 0 \quad \text{concave, relative maximum}$$

$$\pi''(-50) = -2(-50) - 10 = 90 > 0 \quad \text{convex, relative minimum}$$

Negative critical values will subsequently be ignored as having no economic significance.

$$3) \pi = -\frac{1}{2}(40)^3 - 5(40)^2 + 2000(40) - 326 = 50,340.67$$

Note: In testing the second-order conditions, as in step 2, always take the second derivative from the original first derivative (4.1) before any negative number has been factored out. Taking the second derivative from the first derivative after a negative has been factored out, as in (4.2), will

reverse the second-order conditions and suggest that the function is maximized at $Q = -50$ and minimized at $Q = 40$. Test it yourself.

- d) $\pi = -Q^3 - 6Q^2 + 144Q - 545$
- 1) $\pi' = -3Q^2 - 12Q + 144 = 0$
 $-3(Q - 20)(Q + 24) = 0$
 $Q = 20 \quad Q = -24$ critical values
 - 2) $\pi'' = -6Q - 12$
 $\pi''(20) = -6(20) - 12 = -132 < 0$ concave, relative maximum
 - 3) $\pi = -(20)^3 - 6(20)^2 + 144(20) - 545 = 17,855$

- 4.18. From each of the following total cost TC functions, find (1) the average cost AC function, (2) the critical value at which AC is minimized, and (3) the minimum average cost.

- a) $TC = Q^3 - 5Q^2 + 60Q$
- 1) $AC = \frac{TC}{Q} = \frac{Q^3 - 5Q^2 + 60Q}{Q} = Q^2 - 5Q + 60$
 - 2) $AC' = 2Q - 5 = 0 \quad Q = 2.5$
 $AC'' = 2 > 0$ convex, relative minimum
 - 3) $AC(2.5) = (2.5)^2 - 5(2.5) + 60 = 53.75$

Note that whenever the value of the second derivative is positive over the whole domain of the function, as in (2) above, we can also conclude that the function is strictly convex and at a global minimum.

- b) $TC = Q^3 - 21Q^2 + 500Q$
- 1) $AC = \frac{Q^3 - 21Q^2 + 500Q}{Q} = Q^2 - 21Q + 500$
 - 2) $AC' = 2Q - 21 = 0 \quad Q = 10.5$
 $AC'' = 2 > 0$ convex, relative minimum
 - 3) $AC = (10.5)^2 - 21(10.5) + 500 = 389.75$

- 4.19. Given the following total revenue and total cost functions for different firms, maximize profit π for the firms as follows: (1) Set up the profit function $\pi = TR - TC$, (2) find the critical value(s) where π is at a relative extremum and test the second-order condition, and (3) calculate the maximum profit.

- a) $TR = 1400Q - 6Q^2 \quad TC = 1500 + 80Q$
- 1) $\pi = 1400Q - 6Q^2 - (1500 + 80Q)$
 $= -6Q^2 + 1320Q - 1500$
 - 2) $\pi' = -12Q + 1320 = 0$
 $Q = 110$ critical value
 $\pi'' = -12 < 0$ concave, relative maximum
 - 3) $\pi = -6(110)^2 + 1320(110) - 1500 = 71,000$

$$b) \quad TR = 1400Q - 7.5Q^2 \quad TC = Q^3 - 6Q^2 + 140Q + 750$$

(4.3)

$$1) \quad \pi = 1400Q - 7.5Q^2 - (Q^3 - 6Q^2 + 140Q + 750)$$

$$= -Q^3 + 1.5Q^2 + 1260Q - 750$$

$$2) \quad \pi' = -3Q^2 + 3Q + 1260 = 0$$

$$= -3(Q^2 + Q - 420) = 0$$

$$= -3(Q + 21)(Q - 20) = 0$$

$$Q = -21 \quad Q = 20 \quad \text{critical values}$$

Take the second derivative directly from (4.3), as explained in Problem 4.17(c), and ignore all negative critical values.

$$\pi'' = -6Q - 3$$

$$\pi''(20) = -6(20) - 3 = -123 < 0$$

concave, relative maximum

$$3) \quad \pi = -(20)^3 - 1.5(20)^2 + 1260(20) - 750 = 15,850$$

$$c) \quad TR = 4350Q - 13Q^2 \quad TC = Q^3 - 5.5Q^2 + 150Q + 675$$

$$1) \quad \pi = 4350Q - 13Q^2 - (Q^3 - 5.5Q^2 + 150Q + 675)$$

$$= -Q^3 - 7.5Q^2 + 4200Q - 675$$

$$2) \quad \pi' = -3Q^2 - 15Q + 4200 = 0$$

$$= -3(Q^2 + 5Q - 1400) = 0$$

$$= -3(Q + 40)(Q - 35) = 0$$

$$Q = -40 \quad Q = 35 \quad \text{critical values}$$

$$\pi'' = -6Q - 15$$

$$\pi''(35) = -6(35) - 15 = -225 < 0 \quad \text{concave, relative maximum}$$

$$3) \quad \pi = -(35)^3 - 7.5(35)^2 + 4200(35) - 675 = 94,262.50$$

$$d) \quad TR = 5900Q - 10Q^2 \quad TC = 2Q^3 - 4Q^2 + 140Q + 845$$

$$1) \quad \pi = 5900Q - 10Q^2 - (2Q^3 - 4Q^2 + 140Q + 845)$$

$$= -2Q^3 - 6Q^2 + 5760Q - 845$$

$$2) \quad \pi' = -6Q^2 - 12Q + 5760 = 0$$

$$= -6(Q^2 + 2Q - 960) = 0$$

$$= -6(Q + 32)(Q - 30) = 0$$

$$Q = -32 \quad Q = 30 \quad \text{critical values}$$

$$\pi'' = -12Q - 12$$

$$\pi''(30) = -12(30) - 12 = -372 < 0 \quad \text{concave, relative maximum}$$

$$3) \quad \pi = -2(30)^3 - 6(30)^2 + 5760(30) - 845 = 112,555$$

4.20. Prove that marginal cost (MC) must equal marginal revenue (MR) at the profit-maximizing level of output.

$$\pi = TR - TC$$

To maximize π , $d\pi/dQ$ must equal zero.

$$\frac{d\pi}{dQ} = \frac{dTR}{dQ} - \frac{dTC}{dQ} = 0$$

$$\frac{dTR}{dQ} = \frac{dTC}{dQ}$$

$$MR = MC \quad \text{Q.E.D.}$$